

Amanda Richer

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Displacement consultant, writer, and human-rights advocate working at the intersection of homelessness policy, community health, and the One Health framework, where human, animal, and environmental wellbeing are treated as inseparable. Her direct knowledge of homelessness runs through the work rather than beside it: guiding researchers working with displaced populations, advising public utilities and NGOs, securing resources for unhoused communities, and representing civil society from King County to the United Nations. She advocates for and helps shape policy addressing the root causes of homelessness, and carries it across writing, documentary photography, teaching, and public testimony.

HUMAN RIGHTS & GOVERNANCE LEADERSHIP

EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE · FORMER CHAIR, MEMBER STATE OUTREACH

2022 – Present

UN Working Group to End Homelessness

Serve on the Executive Committee and Member State Outreach Committee of the UN civil-society working group; formerly chaired member-state outreach, engaging governments in the group's work to end homelessness.

SPEAKER & SUBJECT MATTER EXPERT

Present

National Health Care for the Homeless Council

National presenter and subject-matter expert on displacement and health.

CHAIR · FORMERLY CO-CHAIR

Present

Seattle Public Utilities — Consumer Review Panel

Chair the panel advising the utility's work and presence within communities.

ADVISORY BOARD

Present

Housing Narrative Lab

Advise on narrative strategies to end homelessness.

FORMER CHAIR, GOVERNANCE COUNCIL

2022 – 2023

Seattle / King County Health Care for the Homeless Network

CONSULTING & EXPERIENCE

DISPLACEMENT CONSULTANT

Oct 2018 – Present

Center for One Health Research, University of Washington

- Guide researchers working with displaced populations.
- Review and edit materials for unhoused communities.
- Connect UW with King County service providers.
- Lead educational panels and serve as subject-matter expert for government, non-profit, and academic organizations.

CO-FOUNDER

May 2018 – Present

ShelterApp / OutreachApp

- Co-developed a national website and app that removes barriers to resources (shelterapp.org).
- Collaborate with national partners to grow reach and validate data.

City of Seattle, Dept. of Neighborhoods · Independent Contractor

- Engaged NGOs and vulnerable communities to gather feedback on City programs.
- Informed project planning with community-sourced data.

SELECTED WRITING

The Architecture of Displacement

ESSAY SERIES · ONGOING

How federal budget and policy changes (OBBBA, FY27) reshape homelessness systems and the people inside them.

The Culling of Americans

WHITE PAPER

Converging federal policy harms — Medicaid, SNAP, caregiver labor — examined as structural violence.

NGO Compliance and Displacement

LONG-FORM ANALYSIS

How preemptive NGO compliance with HUD Continuum of Care overhauls can become complicity in displacement.

Runta News

GUEST REPORTING

Reporting on displacement, community health, and human rights for an outlet serving Somali and Muslim communities.

SELECTED SPEAKING & TESTIMONY

- CSW70 — UN Commission on the Status of Women (presenter)
- UNITAR — UN Institute for Training and Research (presenter)
- National Health Care for the Homeless Council — Annual Conference (presenter)
- National Alliance to End Homelessness — National Conference (presenter)
- University of Washington — research presentations

SKILLS

POLICY ADVOCACY & ANALYSIS

RESEARCH

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

OUTREACH & RESOURCE DEVELOPMENT

COMMUNICATION & EDUCATION

LEADERSHIP & TEAMWORK

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

COURSEWORK

Psychology, Mount Senario College

CONTINUING ED

Johns Hopkins & Emory — Psychological First Aid; Infectious Disease Transmission Models for Decision-Makers; Communicating During Global Emergencies; COVID-19 Contact Tracing

CERTIFICATION

AHA CPR & First Aid (2024)

RESEARCH

Ongoing independent research — displacement, homelessness policy, and One Health

IN DEVELOPMENT

A human-rights gaming app for experiential learning

REFERENCES

Available upon request.